

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

There is some bad news at the office.



Learning Outcome

Present advice on solving technical problems in a work context and appropriate for the interlocutor.

Can Do Statements

- I can react to and comment on a story.
- I can talk about experiences I've had.
- I can talk about jobs and work.

Ask your partner:

- When was the last time you heard some shocking news or bad news at work?
- How did you react? What did you say?





Let's Explore!

Janet and Miranda have an important meeting. What do they talk about?



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Janet: Hi Miranda, what's wrong?

Miranda: You won't believe this. Have you used the social media website Chirp? There's been a leak from an employee at Holly's.

Janet: Uh-oh. This sounds serious ...

Miranda: This explains why Farmani has been reluctant to discuss training and personnel needs.

Janet: Go on.

Miranda: The word is out that he has planned a massive layoff of employees.

Janet: Oh my gosh! What was he thinking? Has he considered the impact this could have on his brand?

Miranda: Not only that, this leak has come out just before our major publicity event. This will hit the press immediately.

Janet: I can't believe it!

Miranda: Believe it. There'll be demonstrations at the event.

Janet: Wow. This is insane. Let's calm down for a minute and think. Publicity event or not, this action will damage his firm's reputation.

Miranda: No wonder he's been so silent.

Janet: That's typical of him. But hear me out. Perhaps, if we move quickly, this is just the right timing.

Miranda: How is that?

Janet: A huge layoff is bad press at any time. But Farmani may be convinced of the seriousness with the timing of our PR event.

Miranda: Ah ... I never thought of that.

Janet: I'll give him a call and convince him to make an announcement we'll publicize at the event. It could be the perfect time to rebrand. I'll urge him to consider retraining his employees rather than hiring new people.

Miranda: Brilliant!





Let's Practice!

Farmani has planned a massive* layoff!

*"Massive": means very large in size or number.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence. Write each word in the correct order. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1) social / the / you / ? / media / Have / website / Chirp / used

2) been / . / There's / leak / a / from / employee / an

3) has / Farmani / discuss / needs / training / to / reluctant / been / and / personnel / .

4) this / on / his / he / brand / could / the / ? / Has / have / considered / impact

5) / . / before / just / has / leak / publicity / major / event / out / our / come / This



Let's Practice!

This story is unbelievable!

Instructions: Read the dialogue. Underline all the words and sentences that indicate reaction or a comment on a story. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Janet: What's wrong?

Miranda: You won't believe this. Have you used Chirp? Someone leaked important information to the media.

Janet: Uh oh. This sounds serious.

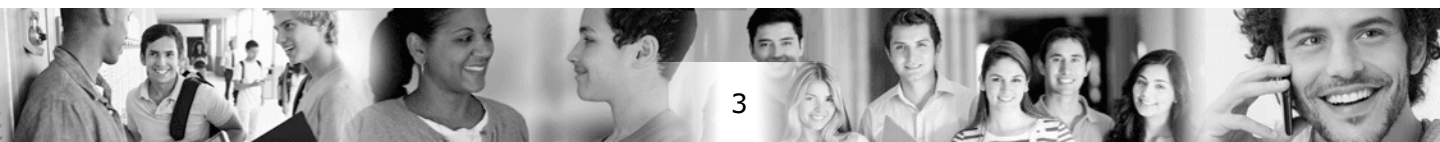
Miranda: He's planned a massive layoff of employees.

Janet: Oh my gosh. What is he thinking?

Miranda: There will be demonstrations at the event.

Janet: Wow. This is insane! This will damage the firm's reputation.

Miranda: No wonder he's been silent.





Extension Activity

Describe and react to personal or news stories.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- You are going to talk about your life.
- Write down a list of three to five different stories about your personal life or news events' you have heard recently.
- Tell the stories to your partner.
- Your partner will react and comment on your stories.
- When you are finished, switch roles and comment on your partner's stories.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write about personal experiences I've had.

☐ ☐

I describe my stories to a partner.

☐ ☐

I react and comment on a story.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **reluctant** (adjective): feeling hesitant or not willing to do something
e.g. Farmani has been reluctant to discuss training and personnel needs.
- **layoff** (noun): a situation in which an employer ends a worker's employment
e.g. He's planned a massive layoff of employees.
- **brand** (noun): a particular identity or image that has its own name and is made by one particular company
e.g. Has he considered the impact this could have on his brand?
- **demonstration** (noun): an occasion when a large group of people protest about something
e.g. There will be demonstrations at the event.
- **bad press** (expression): criticism that appears in newspapers, magazines, or other media
e.g. A huge layoff is bad press at any time.
- **to publicize** (verb): to publish or broadcast information about something or someone
e.g. I'll give him a call and convince him to make an announcement we'll publicize at the event.
- **to rebrand** (verb): to change the corporate image of a company or organization
e.g. This could be the perfect time to rebrand.
- **leak** (noun): telling private or secret information to journalists or to the public
e.g. There's been a leak from an employee at Holly's.





Learning Points

Using Interjections & Expressions to React and Comment on a Story

When you listen to a story, it is always important to react and comment on it. You do this by using interjections or phrases to express emotion. Here are some common ones and examples of their use in conversations:

Examples:

- **A:** *Hey, what happened?*
- B:** ***You won't believe this.** There's a leak announcing a huge layoff.*
- A:** ***Uh-oh! This is not good.***
- **A:** *The company decided to fire more than 300 employees.*
- B:** ***Oh my gosh! I can't believe it!***
- **A:** *No wonder, he's been so quiet.*
- B:** *Wow! This is insane!*
- A:** *That's typical of him.*

Present Perfect

The Present Perfect is a combination of the Present tense and the Perfect aspect. The *tense* demonstrates the position of an event or action **in time**. In the Present Perfect, you use a past tense (past participle) because the action happened at a time in the past. The *aspect* refers to how you should view the event in relation to time (in other words the **perspective**). In the Present Perfect, you use a Perfect aspect - the event has a connection to the present time.

The Present Perfect is used to express a past event that has present consequences.

Forming the Present Perfect

+	<i>I / you / we / they</i>	have used the social media website Chirp. [<i>'ve used</i>]
	<i>He / she / it</i>	has used the social media website Chirp. [<i>'s used</i>]
-	<i>I / you / we / they</i>	haven't used the social media website Chirp. [<i>have + not</i>]
	<i>He / she / it</i>	hasn't used the social media website Chirp. [<i>has + not</i>]
?	Have you / I / we / they	used the social media website Chirp?
	Has he / she / it	





Learning Points

Using the Present Perfect

1. Indefinite time before now: We use the Present Perfect to describe an action that happened in the past but we don't know exactly when. The time is NOT important.

- *There's **been** a leak on social media.*
- *He's **planned** a layoff that will affect the company.*

Remember: You must not use any time expressions such as *yesterday, last week, two months ago*.

- ~~*There has been a leak on social media*~~ **yesterday**.

1. Recent past action: The Present Perfect is also used to talk about a recent past action. We normally use "just".

- *This news **has just come out**.*

1. Experiences: The Present Perfect describes experiences a person has had or hasn't had. We normally use the expression "*Have you ever + past participle*" to ask about people's experiences.

- *"**Have you ever used** Chirp?"*

